Cannabis topicals: HMTc Standard

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CITE AS

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CORRESPONDENCE

Corrections are logged publicly on the article page, each with its date, the affected value, and the source that resolved it.

KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

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Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified heavy-metal-safety standard for cannabis topicals (Cannabis, Hemp, and CBD Products), evaluated on the finished topical/transdermal product as sold. Each limit is the strictest sovereign cannabis heavy-metal action level applicable to the dermal route; total chromium is a screening ceiling with hexavalent chromium as the binding control, and inorganic arsenic, methylmercury and Cr(VI) are enforced by reflex speciation.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default, route-preserving; strictest applicable sovereign cannabis maximum; occurrence never selects a value)

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

ANALYTE	TIER	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	Tier 1	500	sovereign maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	Tier 1	500	sovereign maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	Tier 2	500	sovereign maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	Tier 1	—	—
Mercury, total (tHg)	Tier 1	100	sovereign maximum level
Methylmercury (MeHg)	Tier 1	—	—

Nickel (Ni)	Tier 2	—	—
Tin (Sn)	Tier 2	—	—
Aluminium (Al)	Tier 2	—	—
Total chromium (Cr)	Tier 2	1,100,000	sovereign maximum level
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	Tier 2	—	—

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	500	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	500	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	500	government maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	—	—
Mercury, total (tHg)	100	government maximum level
Methylmercury (MeHg)	—	—
Nickel (Ni)	—	—
Tin (Sn)	—	—
Aluminium (Al)	—	—
Total chromium (Cr)	1,100,000	government maximum level
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	—	—

4 | Cite this standard

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STATUS AND LICENCE

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COMPETING INTERESTS

This briefing is published by the Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) program, operated by the Institute of Contaminant Standards. Its statements about government regulations, toxicology, and occurrence are sourced to the cited primary and expert-body records and to the

independently maintained Heavy Metal Index; the program's own certification thresholds are not used as evidence for any factual claim made here.

DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/-cannabis-topicals. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08. The full dated record is maintained at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/-cannabis-topicals.